NATIONAL FOOD SECURITY ACT (NFSA) - TARGETED PUBLIC DISTRIBUTION SYSTEM

SUPPLEMENTARY REFERENCE - Compiled from Official Government Portals (November 2026)

Department of Food and Public Distribution, Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Government of India | Level: Central & State Joint | Category: Food Security & Social Welfare

Official Portal: https://dfpd.gov.in and https://nfsa.gov.in

1. Overview & Legal Entitlement

The National Food Security Act (NFSA), 2013 legally entitles up to 75% of rural and 50% of urban population (over 81 crore citizens) to receive subsidized foodgrains under the Targeted Public Distribution System (TPDS). Under Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana (PMGKAY), foodgrains are provided 100% free of cost.

2. Beneficiary Categories & Grain Entitlements

- Antyodaya Anna Yojana (AAY): Poorest of the poor families receive 35 kg of foodgrains per family per month (fixed allocation regardless of family size).
- Priority Households (PHH): Eligible low-income and vulnerable families receive 5 kg of foodgrains per person per month.
- Pricing: Under the central decision effective 2023-2028, NFSA grains (Rice, Wheat, Coarse Grains) are distributed completely FREE at Fair Price Shops (FPS).
- One Nation One Ration Card (ONORC): Beneficiaries can lift entitled foodgrains from any biometric e-PoS Fair Price Shop anywhere in India using Aadhaar.

3. Eligibility Criteria & Identification

- Beneficiaries identified by respective State/UT Governments based on socio-economic criteria.
- Rural Inclusion: Agricultural landless labourers, marginal farmers, rural artisans, households headed by widows, terminally ill persons, primitive tribal households.
- Urban Inclusion: Daily wage earners, domestic workers, rickshaw pullers, street vendors, construction labourers, beggars, homeless destitute.
- Exclusion: Households with members owning pucca houses of specified area, motorized four-wheelers, regular government employees, or income taxpayers.

4. Required Documents Checklist

1. Aadhaar Card of all family members to be seeded on Ration Card.
2. Domicile / Residence Proof (Electricity bill, LPG connection book, rent agreement).
3. Income Certificate issued by Revenue Authority (Tahsildar / Village Administrative Officer).
4. Recent passport-size family photograph showing family head.
5. Bank account passbook of the female head of the family (designated head of household under NFSA).

5. Application Procedure

Step 1: Visit state food and civil supplies portal (e.g., ahara.kar.nic.in in Karnataka, fcs.up.gov.in in UP) or nearest Gram One / CSC / Seva Kendra.
Step 2: Submit application for New BPL / PHH / AAY Ration Card with Aadhaar e-KYC of all members.
Step 3: Food Inspector / Revenue Inspector conducts field verification of economic status.
Step 4: Upon verification, digital Ration Card is approved and physical RC or e-Ration card is issued.
Step 5: Collect foodgrains monthly by biometric fingerprint authentication at any Fair Price Shop.